declared zones of special interest around the world while attacking the USSR for doing the same thing.

Finally it was my turn and I took Gorbachev through the long history of Soviet aggression, citing chapter and verse of the Soviet Union's policy of expansionism from 1917 onward. I wanted to explain why the Free World had good reason to put up its guard against the Soviet bloc.

As we broke for lunch, I assured Gorbachev he could have the floor next to rebut me, and he used it, arguing again that we had no reason to be suspicious of the Soviets—they were peace-loving and good citizens. When it was my turn to make a rebuttal, I cited more reasons for our skepticism about the Soviets such as the Soviet betrayal of Stalin's promise at Yalta to hold free elections in the nations of Eastern Europe after World War II.

After I finished my rebuttal, our arms control experts were given the floor, and it was during this pause that I suggested to Gorbachev that the two of us walk down to the boat house for a breath of fresh air and a talk. He leaped out of his chair almost before I finished.

The fire was roaring when we got to the cottage and sat down across from each other in stuffed chairs beside the hearth. I had considered suggesting to him that we go on a first-name basis, as our group did at economic summits, but our experts had told me he wasn't likely to appreciate such a gesture of informality at our first meeting, and so I addressed him as "Mr. General Secretary."

It was during the first moments of this fireside chat that I said I thought the two of us were in a unique situation. Here we were, I said, two men who had been born in obscure rural hamlets in the middle of our respective countries, each of us poor and from humble beginnings. Now we were the leaders of our countries and probably the only two men in the world who could bring about World War III.